To: Nilesh Agrawal, Finance Controller · **Re:** Reading expense receipts automatically · **Date:** 15 October 2026

Recommendation

Read every bill automatically. Auto-approve a claim under Rs 2,000 only when all checks pass: 86% of small claims did (221 of 258, June–July). Send everything else to a clerk with the reason already written. Do not auto-approve on amount alone.

Accuracy

On 198 processed claims kept aside for testing, the system matched the clerk on 94.7% of fields and the photo on 98.9%. Most disagreements were clerk typing: of 53 checked by hand, 44 were clerk errors (dropped digits, wrong dates, blank GSTINs, inked amounts typed as genuine).

Field	vs clerk	vs photo
Bill date	98.5%	100%
Amount	95.5%	100%
Bill number	93.9%	99.0%
GSTIN	91.9%	99.0%
Vendor	93.9%	96.5%

Against the photo, all five fields clear your 95%; against the clerk's typing, date and amount do.

What it saves

A clerk costs Rs 216 an hour (Rs 76,000 for 352 hours). The 78% of claims approved automatically save 3.5 minutes each. The model costs Rs 0.13 a photo.

	Claims/month	Clerk time saved	Model cost	Net
Company	2,400	109 h, Rs 23,577	Rs 317	**Rs 23,260**
Nagpur	240	11 h, Rs 2,358	Rs 32	**Rs 2,326**

What it recovers

In Nagpur's claims of 9 June – 18 July (283 claims), the checks found repeat bills, altered amounts and over-claims:

- **Under Rs 2,000:** Rs 15,832 on 28 claims. Your plain "auto-approve under Rs 2,000" rule would pay all of it with no human look. The clerks paid Rs 14,383 of it.
- **Rs 2,000 or more:** Rs 2,900 on 2 claims that the clerks saw and approved anyway.

Approved wrongly in all: Rs 17,283. 283 claims is 1.18 months of Nagpur's volume, so that is about **Rs 14,657 a month in Nagpur, Rs 1.47 lakh company-wide**. This is an estimate from about six weeks of one division.

The fake "PRE-VERIFIED" stamp

Five receipts carry a stamp telling "automated processing" to approve the bill and skip the duplicate check. Every one is an altered or repeated bill. A tool that obeys text on the page would have paid them. Ours treats receipt text as evidence, never instructions, and flags the stamp itself.

Faster pay for reps

For Amol: clean claims go straight into the weekly payment run, with no wait for a clerk. Only flagged claims queue.

What I need from you

1. Sign-off on two limits: a bill may differ from the expense date by ±1 day, and may be at most 60 days old.
2. Permission to query the repeat claims found.
3. App fixes from IT: auto-rotate photos, retry failed uploads, save bare file names.
4. A vendor master with GSTINs.
5. An owner for the review queue.
6. A paid API key for production: the free tier stops at 500 photos a day.